

Deep Dive: 18. OOP III: Dunder Methods

Concept Summary

Dunder (Double Under) methods are special built-in methods (like **init**) that Python calls automatically behind the scenes.

Coding Structure

```
def __str__(self):  
    return string
```

Example Code

```
class Book:  
    def __init__(self, title):  
        self.title = title  
    def __str__(self):  
        return f'Book: {self.title}'  
  
b = Book('1984')  
print(b)
```

Code Explanation

- Line 2: The standard **init** dunder method to set up the object.
- Line 4: The **str** dunder method dictates what happens when someone tries to convert the object to a string (like when calling `print()`).
- Line 8: Because of **str**, it prints nicely as 'Book: 1984' instead of an ugly memory address.

Practice Problems

1. Create a User class with a **str** method that returns the user's name and ID.
2. Implement the **len** dunder method in a class so that calling `len(object)` returns a custom integer.